

Masatomo TORIKAI

Latest Update: July 6, 2026

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Academic Appointments

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| 2022– | The University of Osaka , Graduate School of Law and Politics
Associate Professor |
| 2021–2022 | Keio University , Faculty of Law
Post-Doctoral Research Fellow |
| 2020–2021 | Tokai University , School of Humanities and Culture, Department of International Studies
Part-Time Lecturer |

Education

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| 2016–2021 | The University of Tokyo , Graduate School for Law and Politics
Ph.D. in Law |
| 2017–2018 | University of California, Berkeley
Visiting Research Student |
| 2016–2017 | Saint Petersburg State University , Faculty of Political Science
Exchange Student |
| 2014–2016 | The University of Tokyo , Graduate School for Law and Politics
M.A. in Law, Distinction |
| 2009–2014 | The University of Tokyo , Faculty of Law
B.A. in Law, Graduated with honors |

Research Interests

Comparative Politics; Comparative Political Economy; Democratization; Authoritarian Regimes; Ethnicity; Post-Soviet Politics; Machine Politics; Russia; Ukraine.

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- 6 Torikai, Masatomo. 2026. "Surviving Political Disruption: Renomination Patterns of Former Party of Regions Deputies in Post-Euromaidan Ukraine." *Electoral Studies*, accepted.
- 5 Aburamoto, Mari, and Masatomo Torikai. "Legitimacy and Control: The Strategic Use of Minor Opposition Parties in Authoritarian Elections." *Comparative Politics*, Fast Track.
- 4 Torikai, Masatomo. 2023. "Integrating Governor Posts Into the Federal Bureaucratic Structure: Resignation and Post-Tenure Careers of Governors in Russia." *Europe-Asia Studies* 75(10): 1651–1676.
- 3 Torikai, Masatomo. 2023. "Growing Localization and Fragmentation of Patronal Politics: Ukrainian Local Elections since 2010." *Eurasian Geography and Economics* 64(3): 296–321.
- 2 Torikai, Masatomo. 2022. "Remnants of the Ancien Régime: Renomination and Re-election of Former Members of A Demised Ruling Party in Ukraine." *Democratization* 29(7): 1249–1267.

- 1 Torikai, Masatomo. 2019. "Electoral Logic of Governor Rotations in Ukraine: Rulers Authority, Party Strength, and Regional Polarization." *Post-Soviet Affairs* 35(3): 258–276.

Works in Progress

- 3 "Subnational Cadre Rotations for Centralization: Different Appointment Patterns of Outsider and Local Governors in Russia." Under review.
- 2 "Cadre Control and Coercion: How Centralized Appointments of Subnational Officials Intensify Judicial Repression." With Evgenia Olimpieva. Invited to R&R at *Comparative Politics*.
- 1 "Why Do Pro-Russian Parties Flourish? Contextualizing the Rise of Ilan Șor's Parties in Moldova." Under review.

Other Publications

- 6 「アウトサイダーの増加とそのペナルティ: ロシアの知事人事の変化とその選挙動員への影響, 1991-2019 年」 [Proliferation of Outsiders and Its Penalty: Transformation of the Governor Deployments in Russia and Its Effect on Electoral Mobilization, 1991–2019]. 『ロシア・東欧研究』 (Russia and East European Studies), no. 49, 2021, pp. 144–166 (in Japanese).
- 5 Местное самоуправление в Новосибирской области: сравнительный анализ (1991–2020 гг.) // Актуальные проблемы исторических исследований: взгляд молодых ученых: сборник материалов Международной молодежной научной школы-конференции / редкол.: Т. И. Морозова (отв. ред.), И. С. Чернова (отв. секр.) [и др.]; Ин-т истории СО РАН. 2020. С. 230–236 (in Russian).
- 4 「跋扈するクラン政治から垂直的権力の形成へ: ダゲスタンの共和国政府・市郡政府の関係の変遷」 [From Rampant Clan Politics to Consolidation of Power Vertical: Transformation of the Relationship between Regional and Municipal Governments in Dagestan]. 『ロシア・東欧研究』 (Russia and East European Studies), no. 47, 2019, pp. 98–116 (in Japanese).
- 3 「すべてのウクライナ人はオレンジだったのか: 2004 年ウクライナ大統領選における政治マシンと東西亀裂」 [All Ukrainians Were Orange? Political Machine and East-West Division in the 2004 Ukrainian Presidential Elections]. 『スラヴ研究』 (Slavic Studies), no. 65, 2018, pp. 1–38 (in Japanese).
- 2 "Governors Change, Mayors Change? Different Relationship between Municipal and Regional Governments in Tatarstan and Bashkortostan." In *Материалы докладов XII международной молодежной научной конференции «Тинчуринские чтения»*, no. 3, Kazan, 2018, pp. 86–89.
- 1 "Electoral Political Machine in Tatarstan." In *Материалы докладов XII международной молодежной научной конференции «Тинчуринские чтения»*, no. 3, Kazan, 2017, pp. 124–125.

Awards

- Mar. 2021 Special Award for Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation, Graduate Schools for Law and Politics, The University of Tokyo.

Conference Presentations

- Nov. 2024 Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies, Boston.
- Dec. 2022 East Asian Conference on Slavic Eurasian Studies, online.
- Nov. 2022 Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies, Chicago.
- May 2021 Association for the Study of Nationalities, online.
- Jul. 2019 East Asian Conference of Slavic and Eurasian Studies, Tokyo.
- Nov. 2017 Association for Slavic, East European and Eurasian Studies, Chicago.
- Apr. 2016 Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago.
- Jan. 2016 Southern Political Science Association, San Juan, Puerto Rico.

Invited Talks

- Nov. 2020 Academic Seminar of Department of Political Science and International Relations, Higher School of Economics in Saint-Petersburg, online.
- Mar. 2019 International Workshop, “Political and Economic Elites in Russia and Ukraine,” Keio University, Tokyo.
- Mar. 2018 Workshop, “Russia’s 2018 Presidential Elections through the Regional Lenses,” King’s College London.
- Jun. 2017 Todai PolSci Lunch Meeting, Tokyo.
- Apr. 2017 Open Seminar, Center for Comparative History and Political Studies, Perm, Russia.
- Jun. 2016 Todai PolSci Lunch Meeting, Tokyo.

Grants and Fellowships

- 2023–2027 Research Grant, Japan Society for the Promotion of Science.
- 2022–2025 Research Grant, Japan Society for the Promotion of Science; with Kimitaka Matsuzato, Masaaki Higashijima, Atsushi Ogushi, Yu Tachibana, and Takayuki Yoshimura.
- 2021–2025 Research Grant, Japan Society for the Promotion of Science; with Masaaki Higashijima, Ryo Nakai, Yuki Yanai, and Yuki Shiraito.
- 2021–2022 Research Grant, Japan Society for the Promotion of Science.
- 2020–2021 Sasakawa Scientific Research Grant, The Japan Science Society.
- 2019–2020 Research Grant, K. Matsushita Foundation.
- 2019 Nakamura-Suzukawa Research Grant, Slavic-Eurasian Research Center, Hokkaido University.

- 2019 Overseas Research Grant, Murata Science and Education Foundation.
- 2017–2019 Research Grant, Japan Society for the Promotion of Science.
- 2016–2017 Fellowship for Young Researchers, Japan Russia Youth Exchange Center.

Committee Memberships

- 2026– Committee Member, Study Group on Global South Diplomacy, The Japan Institute of International Affairs.
- 2026– Committee Member, Super Science High School Steering Advisory Committee, Yamaguchi Prefectural Tokuyama High School.
- 2023–2026 Committee Member, Study Group on Russia, The Japan Institute of International Affairs.

Selected Fieldwork and Service

- Aug.–Sep. 2024 Field research in Moldova: Chişinău, Bălţi, and Comrat.
- Jul.–Aug. 2019 Field research in Russia: Novosibirsk.
- Sep.–Dec. 2018 Field research in Russia: Tambov and Kemerovo.
- Feb.–Jun. 2017 Field research in Russia: Tatarstan, Bashkortostan, Chuvashia, and Dagestan.
- Jun.–Jul. 2015 Field research for master's thesis in Ukraine: Kyiv, Kherson, and Dnipropetrovsk.
- 2017, 2019 Discussant, chair, and volunteer staff roles at Slavic and Eurasian studies conferences.

Reviewer

Problems of Post-Communism; Post-Soviet Affairs; Comparative Political Studies.

Languages and Technical Skills

Languages: Japanese (native); English and Russian (fluent); Ukrainian, Polish, Romanian, and Serbo-Croatian (basic).

Technical skills: R, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Quarto.